Decimals & operation order

QUICK REFERENCE | Suggested grades 4-6 | Math

Read places carefully and estimate before calculating.

Read 3.456

Ones	Tenths	Hundredths	Thousandths
3	4	5	6

Add and subtract

Line up decimal points. Add zeros to show equal places.

2.40 + 0.35 = 2.75. 5.00 - 1.28 = 3.72.

Multiply decimals

Multiply as whole numbers. Count decimal places in BOTH factors.

1.2 x 0.3: 12 x 3 = 36. Two decimal places total gives 0.36.

Divide by a decimal

Multiply BOTH numbers by the same power of 10 to make the divisor whole.

4.8 divided by 0.6 = 48 divided by 6 = 8.

Order of operations

1. Grouping symbols, such as parentheses. 2. Exponents.

3. Multiply and divide from left to right.

4. Add and subtract from left to right.

Example: 18 - 6 divided by 3 x 2 = 18 - 2 x 2 = 18 - 4 = 14.

OPP